



October 2006

Bitten By The Anti-piracy Bug

I recently bought the PC of my dreams, which I wanted to do for over a year. All thanks to you guys. I decided—like all the other fans of my favourite Digit-ian Agent001 out there—to go paid. I decided on a legal copy of Windows XP Home for Rs 3,800. Something happened which I would like to share with all the “please go paid” fans you inspired...

My vendor showed me two packs of Windows XP: one was a thin SIM-card-style package, which he said was an old one, and another was a plastic box (read hopelessly transparent) package. In the new package, the CD got dislodged from the cover when I accidentally tapped the side of the box, and this revealed the CD key (with genuineness certificate and all)! Thinking that this was a package defect, I asked the dealer for another pack, and the same thing happened again!

Couldn't people misuse this information and pirate the copy before it was even sold? Now why would people want to pay for software whose developers don't even bother to keep the information secure?

Anyway, as always, your magazine is the best one there is, and your *Fast Track* issues rock. Hope you include this letter in the mag!

Siddharth P Shanbhogue
Mysore

Dear Siddharth,
Your vendor is obviously a pirate. It's not that the companies don't bother to keep the license information secure—your vendor had

obviously opened the packages to make a list of working license keys.

What can I say—except that the only thing you could and should have done is to walk out of that store, telling the vendor you wouldn't purchase a PC from someone who pirates software keys! I hope this message reaches out to more such readers like you, who have (thankfully) been bitten by the “go paid” bug.

— Executive Editor

I Want Code!

I am a second-year BCA student doing a computer hardware and networking course at Jetking. I've found that *Digit* is very helpful in my studies. I request you to send some notice on languages like C, C++, Java, HTML, etc. If you have extra notice on B.C.A., please provide that as well. Most of the people (85 per cent) in my class buy *Digit*, and this is a joint request—thanks!

Kanwaljeet Singh,
Bathinda, Punjab

Dear Kanwaljeet,
I'm not quite sure what you mean by “notice,” but if you mean information, we have plans to cover programming languages in upcoming issues of *Fast Track* as well as the magazine.

— Executive Editor

Thank You My Friend!

I read *Digit* for the first time in January 2002, and since then, it has been my best friend. I did not subscribe to the magazine, but I've never missed a single issue. It not only taught me how to troubleshoot computers, but also kept me updated with technology. I was accustomed to using pirated software and I had all the popular software. But now I only use either licensed software or Open Source software. Thank you, *Digit*, for being my best teacher and best friend!

Vedant Choudhary

Dear Vedant,
We're extremely glad to have got the message about piracy across—your letter is the second one this month that talks about using legal software, and that doesn't include the unpublished letters! Thanks for writing in!

— Executive Editor

I Want It All

I have been reading your magazine for the past two months. The *Fast Track* series is really good. But I could only lay my hands on two of them! Is there any way to get all the *Fast Track* books, free software, and game CDs—for a price and at one go? I'd be grateful if you could tell me how.

Kishore

Dear Kishore,
We're sorry to tell you that you can't—apart from the fact that we provide the entire *Fast Track* series as PDFs on the CD/DVD once a year. You can get all the previous issues of our *Fast Track* series on our December 2006 CD. That apart, how about getting yourself a subscription of the magazine—since you liked the two issues you bought, we're sure it'll grow on you!

— Executive Editor

Jukeboxes Rule

Your article on the Home Jukebox had perfect timing. I recently acquired a Samsung Bordeaux 40-inch beauty and was looking for a way to watch all my DivX movies and also my huge collection of digital photographs on it. A DVD player just didn't cut it.

I had an old machine (a Pentium III 550 MHz with around 128 MB of RAM) lying unused, so I thought of putting it to good use. I installed a Wi-Fi card, a friend's old 40 GB HDD (plus the 20 GB drive that was already in it), and a USB TV-Tuner! Now I can watch all my movies and pictures in high definition! And believe me, it's glorious! Since the system is already hooked up to the home theatre for audio, I can also play back my music collection over wireless!

Do you guys know whether GeeXboX is dual-boot compatible? Because I'd like it if XP were there too... in case I ever needed it!

Reeve Luiz

Dear Reeve,
Well done! Lots of people like you have loved that article, so keep watching these pages for more along these lines.

Yes, GeeXboX is dual-boot compatible—it installs the GRUB boot-loader when you put it on your hard disk, and that will detect your Windows installation. Just make sure you install Windows first!

— Executive Editor